Gal Bitton

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Last Updated: November 4, 2026

Appointment

The Hebrew University of Jerusalem *January 2027 -*
Lecturer (Assistant Professor), Department of International Relations

Harvard University *January 2026-December 2026*
Postdoctoral Fellow, Mossavar Rahmani Center for Business and Government (M-RCBG), Harvard Kennedy School of Government

Harvard University *January 2025-December 2025*
Postdoctoral Fellow, Weatherhead Scholars Program, Weatherhead Center for International Affairs

Education

Tel-Aviv University *2025*
Ph.D. in Political Science
Dissertation: "*From Barriers to Bridges: The Cultural Roots of International Financial Engagement*"

Tel-Aviv University *2021*
M.A., Magna cum Laude, Political Science

Tel-Aviv University *2018*
B.A., Political Science

Research Interests

(International) political economy; Foreign policy analysis; Behavioral economics; Comparative politics; Political attitudes & behavior; Survey design and experimental methods.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- "When Effort Is Not Enough: Political Identity and Welfare Deservingness in a Polarized Society." **Journal of European Public Policy** (*Forthcoming*) (with Clareta Treger).
  Pre-registration
  Pre-print
- "Shifting Sands? The Impact of Conflict Displacement on Voting Patterns." **Political Studies** *(2026).*
  OnlineFirst
  Pre-registration
- "Rally Around the Winner – A Two-Wave Panel Survey on the Impact of the U.S. Elections on Foreign Policy Stances." **International Journal of Public Opinion Research** (2025) (with Eyal Rubinson).

Conditional Acceptance

- "How Does Cultural Identity Shape Global Financial Engagements?" (*Revise & Resubmit, Business and Politics*).

- "Assembling Security Consensus: Political Violence, Ideology, and Support for State Surveillance." (with Daphna Canetti, Giulia Dal Bello, Julia Elad-Strenger, and Sivan Hirsch-Hoefler) (*Revise & Resubmit, Journal of Peace Research*).

Research in Preparation

Under Review

- "The Premium of Familiarity: Experimental Evidence on Financial Interactions Between Foreigners." (*Review of International Political Economy*).
  Pre-registration
- "Are findings of research on the Effectiveness of International Economic Organizations generalizable?" (with Tal Sadeh and Bernhard Reinsberg) (*Review of International Political Economy*).
- "When Does War Exposure Become Political Violence? Distress, Cognitive Flexibility, and Domestic Violent Intentions." (with Daphna Canetti, Sivan Hirsch-Hoefler, and Tal Shaanan) (*British Journal of Political Science*).
- "International Authority and Electoral Accountability." (with Tal Sadeh, Benjamin Daßler, and Yuval Hirshorn) (*Review of International Political Economy*).
  Pre-registration
- "The Politics of Restraint: Violence Exposure and Foreign Policy Attitudes Across Conflict Phases" (with Keren LG Snider, Amit Cohen and Daphna Canetti) (*International Studies Quarterly*).
- "Backsliding Divides, War Unites: Threat, Ideology, and Political Trust Across Internal and External Crises in Israel." (with Keren LG Snider) (*Democratization*).
- "Political Violence and the Hierarchy of Exclusion: How Mass Trauma Restructures Outgroup Attitudes." (with Keren LG Snider and Shani Fachter) (*Political Behavior*).

Working Papers

- "The Effect of Targeted Corrections of High Salience Misperceptions on Partisan Threat Attribution, Antidemocratic Attitudes, and Support for Political Violence." (with Sam Fuller and Jack T. Rametta).
- "Who Deserves a Safety Net? Labour-Market Dualization and Moral Heuristics." (with Gianluca Busilacchi).
- "Do and When Adverse Banking Conditions Affect Public Support for the Government?" (with Tal Sadeh, and Yuval Hirshorn).
- "Overestimating Support: Elected Politicians' Perceptions of Public Opinion on Foreign Aid Across Eight Countries." (with Lior Sheffer and Eran Amsalem)
  Pre-registration

Work in Progress

- "Elite Cues and Public Support for Security Alliances: A Survey Experiment." (with Eyal Rubinson).
- "Do Voters Reward Eurosceptic Governments?" (with Tal Sadeh)
  Pre-registration

Fellowships

POLPOP III, Tel Aviv University *2025-2027*
Scholar Fellow

The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS), Harvard University *2025-2027*
Scholar Fellow

Center for American Political Studies (CAPS), Harvard University *2025-2027*
Scholar Fellow

The Azrieli Graduate Studies Fellowship *2022-2025*
Pre-doctoral Fellow

- Only about 1.6% of social sciences PhD students are selected each year

The Center for the Study of the United States (CSUS), Tel-Aviv University *2022-2023*
Pre-doctoral Fellow - Partnership with the Fulbright Program

The Edmond J. Safra Center for Ethics, Tel-Aviv University *2021-2022*
Pre-doctoral Fellow

Tel-Aviv University *2019-2025*
Doctoral Fellow

Research Experience

The Institute for Liberty & Responsibility at Reichman University *2022-2025*
Research Assistant Head: Dr. Amnon Cavari

"How Politicians Evaluate Public Opinion" (POLPOP II) *2022-2023*
Research Assistant
ERC-funded research team; PIs: Lior Sheffer (TAU) and Eran Amsalem (HUJI)

Grants

The Tel Aviv University Presidential Scholarship for Post Doctoral Studies for Women *2024-2026*
($50,000)

Research grant from the Institute for Freedom and Responsibility at Reichman University *2024*
(NIS 8,000)

The Azrieli Graduate Studies Fellowship *2022-2026*
(NIS 366,000)

- Only about 1.6% of social sciences PhD students are selected each year

The Center for the Study of the United States (CSUS) in Partnership with the Fulbright Program *2022-2023*
(NIS 3,000)

Research grant from the Institute for Freedom and Responsibility at Reichman University *2022*
(NIS 10,000) - Collaborated with Clareta Treger

Research Grant for outstanding graduate students, Faculty of Social Sciences, Tel-Aviv University *2022*
(NIS 10,000)

Doctoral Fellowship Program at The Edmond J. Safra Center for Ethics, Tel Aviv University *2021-2022*
($20,500)

The Richard and Rhoda Goldman Fellowship Fund Scholarship for the Enhancement of the Quality of Governance, Tel Aviv University *2021*
($5,000)

Awards & Honorable Mentions

Harrell Rodgers Travel Scholarship, Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) *2025*
($500)

- Awarded to only 4% of applicants

Travel Grant, The Society for Political Methodology *2024*
($1,000)

Best Presentation Award, The 4th Haifa International Social Sciences Workshop for Graduate Students *2022*
($700)

Best Submission from Pre-tenure Scholars by the Joint IPE Conference of the DVPW, ÖGPW and SVPW *2022*

Tel Aviv University Graduate Students Excellence Award & Scholarship *2022*
(NIS 7,000)

Reichman University Teaching Assistant Excellence Award & Scholarship *2021*
(NIS 2,000)

Dean's Honor List, B.A. *2017-2018*
(NIS 2,000)

Conference Presentations

American Political Science Association (APSA) *2023, 2024***, 2025*

Canadian Political Science Association (CPSA) *2024**

Political Economy of Aid and International Organization (PEAIO) *2025*

Political Economy of International Organization (PEIO) *2023, 2024, 2025*

Democracy and Political Violence (DPV) Mini-Conference (*Organizer*)
- First Annual Meeting, Harvard University *2026*
- MPSA Conference-within-Conference, Chicago *2027*

(De)polarisation in Values, Attitudes and Beliefs Workshop, King's College London *2024*

DVPW–ÖGPW–SVPW Joint International Political Economy Conference *2022*

ESPAnet Virtual Workshop *2024*

European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR) *2022*

European Union Studies Association (EUSA) *2023***, 2025*

Foreign Aid and Political Gains Workshop, University of Haifa *2023*

Graduate Student International Political Economy (GSIPE)
- Workshop *2021*
- Mini-Conference: Qualitative & Mixed Methods Research in IPE *2021*

Haifa International Social Sciences Workshop for Graduate Students (HSSC) *2022*

IASEI–NYU Workshop *2024*

International Conference of Europeanists *2023**

International Political Economy Society (IPES)
- Annual Meeting *2021, 2025, 2026*
- Virtual IPES *2025*

International Society of Political Psychology (ISPP)
- Annual Meeting *2026*
- Virtual Academy *2024**

International Studies Association (ISA) *2023, 2024*

Israeli Association for International Studies (IAIS)
- Annual Meeting *2022, 2023, 2026*
- Research Colloquium for Ph.D. Students in International Studies *2022*

Israeli Political Science Association (ISPSA) *2022*

Jerusalem–Tel Aviv Forum for Empirical Studies in Politics *2022*

Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) *2022–2025, 2026**

Political Studies Association (PSA) Early Career Network *2024*

Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science *2024, 2025*

Society for Political Methodology (PolMeth)
- Annual Meeting *2022, 2024*
- PolMeth Europe *2022*

Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics (SASE) *2022, 2023*, 2026*

"The end of affective polarisation?" Workshop *2026*

Western Political Science Association (WPSA) *2025**

* *Accepted; cancelled participation.*

Invited Talks

The Policy, Elections, and Representation Lab (PEARL) Munk School of Global Affairs & Public Policy, University of Toronto *March 13, 2023*
"How Does Cultural Identity Shape Financial Policies?"

Panelist; "Europe: a crisis in light of energy", Model UN, TAU *January 9, 2023*

Department of Politics and Public Administration, University of Konstanz *October 28, 2022*
Lecture: "The Premium of Familiarity"

Research Stays & Visits

Visiting doctoral student at the University of Konstanz *2022*
One month (October) Host: Prof. Gerald Schneider

Teaching

Lecturer

The Hebrew University, Department of International Relations

- *The International Financial System and Economic Crises* (graduate) *2027–*
- *The Microfoundations of International Political Economy* (graduate) *2027–*

Teaching Assistant

Reichman University, Lauder School of Government

- *Advanced Research Methods* (graduate) *2020–2024*
- *Intermediate Research Methods* (graduate) *2020–2023*
- *Empirical Research* (undergraduate) *2020–2023*

Tel-Aviv University, School of Political Science

- *Europe in a Crisis* (graduate) *2019–2024*
- *Political Economy in the Global Age* (graduate) *2019–2022*
- *International Political Economy* (graduate) *2019–2022*
- *Introduction to Writing and Research in Political Science* (undergraduate) *2019–2021*
- *Introduction to International Relations and Strategy* (undergraduate) *2019–2021*

Service and Other Academic Activities

- **Reviewer**: Comparative Political Studies; European Journal of International Relations; International Studies Quarterly; Journal of Regulation & Governance.
- **Chair & Discussant**: DPV Mini-Conference; GSIPE Mini-Conference; PEIO Annual Conference; The IA-SEI–NYU Workshop; The 19th European Union Studies Association (EUSA); APSA Annual Meeting.
- **Statistical Consultant**: Provides statistical and analytical assistance for students.
- **Workshops**: Programming and data analysis workshop using STATA: Beginner to Advanced.
- **Mentor**: Project mentor of "Why do I need democracy now?", for undergraduate students. The Unit for Social Involvement at Tel Aviv University (2023-2024).

Technical Reports

- Bitton, G. "A Reflection of Society: Israeli Public Attitudes Toward Political Violence" The Institute for Liberty & Responsibility at Reichman, 2024. Available online.
- Bitton, G. "Does the Israeli Public Want an Anti-Democratic Leader?" The Institute for Liberty & Responsibility at Reichman, 2023. Available online.
- Bitton, G. "Does the Israeli Public Support the Override Clause?" The Institute for Liberty & Responsibility at Reichman, 2023. Available online.
- Bitton, G. "Jewish Identity or Democratic Values - What Do Israelis Prefer?" The Institute for Liberty & Responsibility at Reichman, 2023. Available online.
- Bitton, G. "Trust Crisis in the Israeli Public?" The Institute for Liberty & Responsibility at Reichman, 2022. Available online.

Interviews & Publications in Popular Media

- DemocratTV: "Do Israelis Prefer Less Democratic Leadership Since October 7?" Host journalist: Attila Shumpelvi. Interview available Online.
- Bitton, G. "Believe in Choice - What do Israelis think about abortion?" The Liberal, 22.9.2022. Available online.

Additional Academic Training

- The 2026 ISPP Academy in University of Newcastle, United Kingdom.
- The Third IO Editorial Café workshop during the 2023 annual meeting of the International Studies Association in Montreal.

- Online oTree course at the Nuffield Centre for Experimental Social Sciences, at the University of Oxford (Instructor: Tommaso Batistoni).
- Data Science Bootcamp: a computational tools and programming for text analysis workshop, at Tel Aviv University (Instructor: Koby Mike).

Reasearch Skills

- **Languages**: R, Python, STATA, LaTeX, Markdown.
- **Software**: RStudio, oTree, Git/GitHub, STATA, JMP, SPSS, and Qualtrics.

Languages

- Hebrew (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic).

Community Engagement

Mentor in the "Sawa" program at Tel Aviv University *2021-2024*
Providing academic, personal, and emotional assistance to Israeli-Arab students

Research assistant in The Social Guard *2017-2019*
A non-governmental organization monitoring Knesset activities to promote social justice and increase civic engagement

Non-Academic Certificates

- First Aid, 28-hour training (Awarded by Malar, Israel)
- 200-hour training for yoga teachers (registered with the Yoga Alliance)